

CLOUD VALUE LAB

A partnership to automate, professionalize, and grow your platform

Prepared for David May — March 18, 2026

David — great conversation on Tuesday with you and Eytan. Your vision for Cloud Value Lab is clear, the market opportunity is real, and your content is genuinely differentiated. The challenge is straightforward: you need the operation to run without you doing the manual work, especially once your new role starts next month.

Before putting this together, we did our homework on your space. What we found confirmed what you already know — but puts some numbers behind it. The short version: **\$44.5 billion in cloud waste is sitting on the table right now, the discipline tasked with stopping it has 35,000 professionals and is growing to 100,000 — and there is still no independent, vendor-neutral media platform that serves them.** That is the opening Cloud Value Lab is built for.

YOUR MARKET

Where Cloud Value Lab Stands

The FinOps market is growing from roughly \$15 billion today to nearly \$27 billion by 2030 — a 12.6% CAGR driven by exploding cloud adoption, AI infrastructure costs, and a discipline now present in 48 of the Fortune 50. The practitioner community stands at 35,000 professionals and is on track to hit 100,000 within three years. Despite all of that, the media landscape serving this audience is almost comically thin. Here's what we're seeing:

FinOps Foundation

INDUSTRY STANDARDS BODY

95K community **25.8K** LinkedIn

Certifications & events

Institutional player — sets standards and runs conferences. Not a content competitor, but they define the ecosystem vocabulary. Their audience is your audience.

FinOps Weekly / SmartClouds

CLOSEST DIRECT COMPETITOR

~6,500 subscribers 12K LinkedIn

Vendor-sponsored

Run by a Madrid-based marketing agency whose clients are FinOps vendors. Content is curated links, not original thought leadership. Revenue comes from sponsorships and vendor webinars. This is the model to beat — and your content already outclasses theirs. FinOps X 2025 had 60+ sponsors and 2,000+ attendees, confirming the sponsorship economy is real and growing.

Corey Quinn / Last Week in AWS

DOMINANT PERSONAL BRAND

100K+ Twitter 30K+ newsletter 669 podcast episodes

Massive following but AWS-only. Not multi-cloud FinOps, not a community. His company (Duckbill Group) raised \$7.75M to pivot to software. He's moved away from content — leaving an even bigger opening for a multi-cloud, practitioner-first voice.

Cloud Value Lab

YOUR POSITION TODAY

~1,000 subscribers Organic growth 10% week-on-week

Vendor-neutral. Expert-level interviews. Original content. The differentiators are real — but the infrastructure (site, social presence, content automation, SEO) isn't matching the quality of what you're producing.

The opportunity: The largest FinOps newsletter has only 6,500 subscribers in a discipline that touches 97 of the Fortune 100. The FinOps tooling landscape has exploded from 5 tools to 115+ — and practitioners are increasingly distrustful of vendor-produced content as consolidation accelerates (Flexera alone acquired Spot, ProsperOps, and Chaos Genius in the past 14 months). There is no Stratechery for FinOps. No independent, editorially-driven, vendor-neutral platform at the senior practitioner level. That is exactly the lane Cloud Value Lab can own — with the right infrastructure behind it.

THE AI MOMENT

There is a once-in-a-generation content gap opening right now. AI cost management went from **31% of organizations tracking it in 2024 → 98% in 2026** — the fastest adoption curve in FinOps history. GPU clusters run idle 15–30% of the time. Token-level cost attribution, model routing economics, and AI ROI framing for executives are skills every senior practitioner needs — and almost no content covers them with real depth.

The FinOps Foundation launched a dedicated "FinOps for AI" certification track. The tooling vendors are scrambling. But there is no independent editorial voice that practitioners trust to cut through the noise. **Cloud Value Lab can own this conversation before anyone else does.**

THE PLAN

What We'll Build Together

PHASE 1

Foundation

Platform & Positioning

Before building anything new, we need to establish CVL as a standalone, professional platform — separate from your consulting site, with proper security, analytics, and SEO architecture. This is the baseline that earns trust from the senior practitioners you're targeting. Your content is already better than the competition. Your site needs to match.

- Competitive analysis and positioning strategy — where CVL fits in the FinOps landscape and how to differentiate
- We will build a standalone CVL website — separate from your consulting site, purpose-built for content and community
- HTTPS / SSL implementation — basic credibility your current site is missing
- Google Analytics with engagement tracking — know who's reading, what they care about, and where they drop off
- Site-level SEO architecture — metadata, cross-linking, sitemap, structured data so

search engines find you

- Social media audit — current presence vs. competitors, platform gaps, and a roadmap to close the distance

PHASE 2

Automation

CMS, Content Engine & Distribution

The centerpiece of Phase 2 is a purpose-built CMS for Cloud Value Lab — your own platform to publish, manage, and organize all content without depending on third-party tools. Built on top of that is the automation layer that turns an interview transcript into a published, optimized article distributed across your channels, without you touching it. Your 4-5 hours a week go toward strategy and relationships, not production and admin.

- **Custom CMS** — purpose-built content management system for CVL: publish articles, manage episodes, control layout, and own your data end-to-end
- **Social media publishing engine** — schedule and distribute content across LinkedIn, Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp, and any other platform of your choice
- We will build AI skills and agents to handle the full content workflow — from interview transcript to edited, SEO-optimized, published article, and automatic extraction of the best 60-90 second video or audio clips for social media
- Integrate an email marketing platform for newsletters and promotions — automated subscriber communications, new article alerts, and digest format
- Text messaging — reach your audience directly with alerts, promotions, and updates via SMS
- CRM integration — connect your contact management, track relationships, and tie audience growth to business opportunities
- Ongoing SEO optimization — every piece of content is optimized before it goes live
- AI-powered administration — the operation runs with minimal hands-on time from you
- Content archive system — organized, searchable, tagged library of your expert interviews and articles

On the Horizon: Monetization Roadmap

Once CVL has consistent content flow and a growing subscriber base, the revenue model builds naturally. B2B tech niche newsletters command \$50–\$150+ CPM — and the FinOps vendor landscape has 60+ active sponsors, flush with capital, who need practitioner mindshare. You build the audience, the economics follow. When you're ready, we'll build:

- Vendor sponsorships — annual packages across newsletter, site, and social; comparable platforms charge \$15K–\$75K+ per sponsor per year
- Premium membership tier — gated deep-dive reports, benchmarking data, and peer roundtables (\$49–\$299/month individual, enterprise annual plans)
- Virtual summits and sponsored roundtables — FinOps X drew 60+ sponsors at 2,000+ attendees; a CVL-branded event is a natural extension
- FinOps job board — practitioners earn \$100K–\$160K+; specialized B2B job boards charge \$500–\$2,500 per posting
- Original research reports — State of FinOps-style benchmarking, co-sponsored by vendors at \$10K–\$50K per report
- Subscription management and billing infrastructure

Comparable B2B media communities — Exit Five (B2B marketing), The Pragmatic Engineer (senior engineering) — have built \$1M–\$3M+ ARR on these models with audiences your size or smaller. We'll revisit scope and pricing together when CVL reaches that stage. No surprises.

INVESTMENT

Phase 1 — Foundation

\$4,000

One-time setup (website, SEO, analytics, competitive analysis, content database)

Phase 2 — Content Engine & Distribution

\$1,000 /mo

Monthly retainer (content pipeline, social publishing, newsletter, SEO, AI admin)

If the scope evolves significantly, we revisit the numbers together. This is a partnership — we want it to work for both sides long-term.

For context: comparable services from a mid-size digital agency typically run **\$15,000–\$30,000** for platform setup alone, with ongoing content and distribution retainers of **\$5,000–\$15,000 per month**. We're able to deliver at this price point because of our AI-first approach — the same automation we're building for you is how we operate.

Next Step

Let's connect this weekend to walk through this together and decide what makes sense for where Cloud Value Lab is right now. The window is open — the FinOps discipline is at an inflection point, AI costs have created urgency that wasn't there 18 months ago, the tooling landscape is consolidating, and practitioners are increasingly skeptical of vendor-produced content. FinOps Weekly is the only real content player in your space, and their model has clear weaknesses you can exploit. The sooner the infrastructure matches your content quality, the faster you own that lane — before someone else decides to.

Looking forward to it, David.

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